Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or personal data. It typically happens through fraudulent emails, text messages, or fake websites designed to look legitimate.

Step-by-Step Process:

1. The attacker sends a convincing email or message, often pretending to be a trusted institution (like a bank or university).
2. The message contains urgent language, such as “Your account will be blocked unless you act now.”
3. A link directs the victim to a fake website that closely resembles the real one.
4. The victim enters login credentials or financial details.
5. The attacker collects this information and uses it for fraud, identity theft, or financial gain.

Targets:
Phishing often targets students, employees, and everyday internet users who may not carefully check links or sender addresses. Students are particularly vulnerable because they frequently use online portals and may trust official-looking emails without verifying them.

Consequences:
Victims may lose money, have their identities stolen, or face unauthorized access to academic or financial accounts. In severe cases, phishing can lead to reputational damage, stress, and long-term financial insecurity. For example, a student who shares login details may lose access to their university portal, affecting grades and submissions.

This case highlights the importance of vigilance in digital communication and the need for awareness among college students, along with reporting suspicious activity to cybercrime.gov.in or helpline 1930.